CHANGE MANAGEMENT

# Standard, normal, or emergency?

Three kinds of change, and what each one needs before it goes ahead.

## Standard

**When:** low risk, repeatable, routine, like patching or user provisioning

**Approval:** approved once, in advance, with set steps

## Normal

**When:** the change has potential risk and needs a closer look

**Approval:** full assessment, testing, and CAB approval, then scheduled

## Emergency

**When:** fixing a critical failure or preventing an outage that is about to happen

**Approval:** skips the usual timeline, reviewed afterward

CAB: Change Advisory Board

1. STANDARD CHANGE

# Make routine work boring

Low-risk work that happens again and again does not need a meeting every time. Approve it once and write it down.

**Agree these once**

- The exact steps
- How it is tested
- How it is rolled back

Routine tasks then stay out of the review queue, and the board has time for the changes that carry real risk.

2. NORMAL CHANGE

# Earn the approval before the meeting

Risky work goes through full assessment and CAB approval. A short entry list keeps unready requests off the agenda.

### Bring to the CAB

- An impact assessment
- Evidence of testing
- A timed rollback plan
- A named owner

Put approved changes on one shared calendar so two risky changes do not land in the same window.

3. EMERGENCY CHANGE

# Guard the emergency label

## Is the business losing money or data right now?

**Yes**
Use the emergency path. Fix first, review afterward.

**No**
It waits for the next normal cycle, even if a ticket was late.

> "If you don't, your emergency process will quickly become your standard process."
>
> Modern IT Infrastructure and Operations, Chapter 11

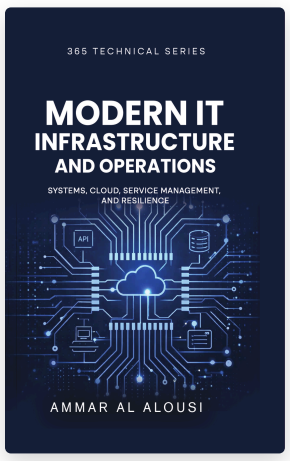
BEFORE ANY CHANGE

# Ask how it gets undone

Before you approve a change, ask the person making it to explain exactly how they would undo it.

> "Should" is hope, not engineering.
>
> Modern IT Infrastructure and Operations, Chapter 11

If they cannot explain exactly how to undo the change in under fifteen minutes, the book's advice is to deny the request.




**Modern IT Infrastructure and Operations** covers change categories, CAB responsibilities, and an example CAB review template in Chapter 11.